



Department of Physical Sciences and Mathematics

AP 190 PRACTICUM GUIDELINES FOR STUDENTS AND PROSPECTIVE SUPERVISOR

A. INTRODUCTION

What is the BS Applied Physics (Health Physics) program about?

The BS Applied Physics (Health Physics) program at the University of the Philippines Manila is a four-year undergraduate degree program that combines a strong foundation in physics with a focus on applications in the field of health and medical physics. The program provides students with a broad range of theoretical knowledge and practical skills related to radiation safety, medical imaging, radiation therapy, and nuclear medicine.

In particular, the program emphasizes the use of physics principles and techniques to understand the behavior of radiation in biological systems and the application of this understanding to the diagnosis and treatment of diseases. The program also emphasizes the importance of safety and regulatory compliance in the use of radiation in medical applications.

The program consists of a mix of classroom instruction, laboratory work, and hands-on experience through internships and research projects. Graduates of the program are prepared for careers in a range of fields, including medical physics, health physics, radiation safety, nuclear medicine, and radiation therapy, as well as for further study in graduate programs in physics, medical physics, or related fields.

What is the significance of the internship program?

The internship program is a crucial component of the BS Applied Physics (Health Physics) program at the University of the Philippines Manila. It provides students with an opportunity to apply their theoretical knowledge and skills in real-world settings, gain practical experience, and develop a deeper understanding of the field of health and medical physics.

Through internships, students can gain exposure to a range of professional settings, including hospitals, research laboratories, and regulatory agencies, and work alongside professionals in the field. This exposure provides them with valuable networking opportunities and can help them to identify potential career paths.

The internship program also enables students to develop important professional skills, such as communication, collaboration, and critical thinking, which are essential for success in the field of health and medical physics. Moreover, the internship program helps students to identify areas of interest within the field and to refine their career goals.

Overall, the internship program is an important aspect of the BS Applied Physics (Health Physics) program, as it helps to prepare students for successful careers in the field of health and medical physics and contributes to the development of a highly skilled and knowledgeable workforce in this critical area of healthcare.





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B. OBJECTIVES

At the end of the program, the student should be able to deliver the following:

BS APPLIED PHYSICS (HEALTH PHYSICS) PROGRAM LEARNING OUTCOMES:

- Apply theoretical, computational, and experimental physics in a workplace;
- Conduct research related to health and medical physics that contribute to national development;
- Advance towards higher knowledge and experience requisite to assuming a leadership role in the health and medical physics profession;
- Collaborate with members of the health and medical physics community and representatives from related health and safety professions;
- Synthesize and effectively communicate scientific information in both English and Filipino; and
- Act in recognition of professional, social, and ethical responsibility.

with the following **AP 190 PRACTICUM COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES (CLO):**

1. Demonstrate an understanding of theoretical knowledge on health physics by performing their duties as a student intern on their chosen institution for at least 200 hours
2. Exemplify professionalism and work ethical standards with different radiation personnel whether in a hospital or an industrial setting
3. Appreciate health physics as a developing field in the country
4. Create a portfolio summarizing the experience of a health physics intern in the field (hospital, research, or industrial setting)

C. General Guidelines

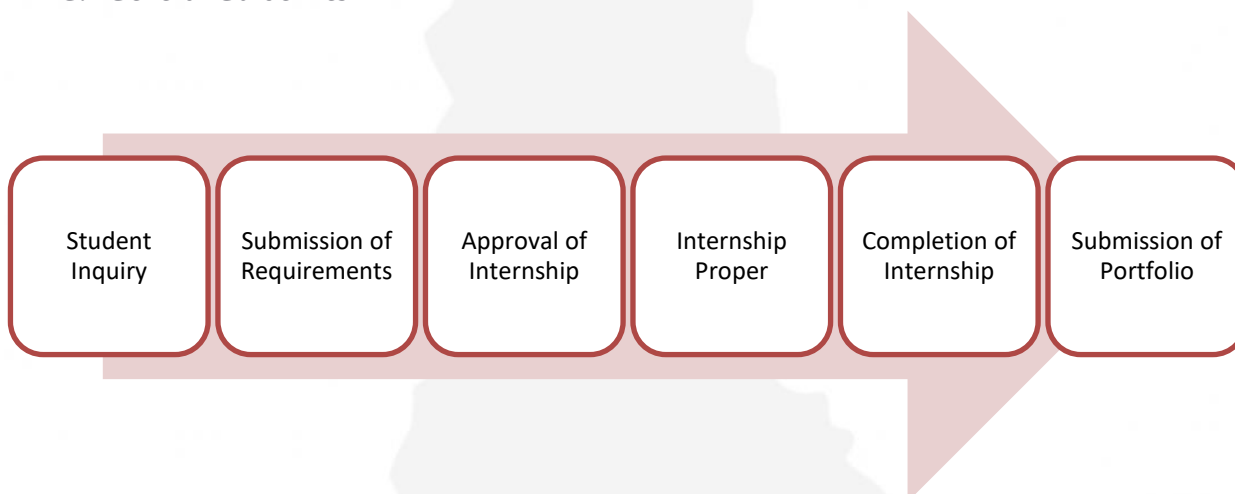


Figure 1: Flowchart of the entire process from application to completion of practicum/internship.

1. Students will research which institutions accept internships and choose one among them to apply for an internship position.
2. Students will collect the required documents by the partner institution (the accepting institution) and submit.





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3. The supervisor will submit a fully accomplished and signed acceptance letter form, indicating the approval of the student internship, with some ideal details of what the training program will be. **(Letter of Acceptance Form and Attachments)**
4. The student intern will fulfill their duties accordingly.
5. Upon completion of the 200-hour training, the supervisor should provide the student with their Certificate of Completion, signed by the supervisor and/or other authorities in the partner institution. Certificate Template is provided by the institution or the OJT-Coordinator if requested.
6. Students will submit their portfolio to the OJT-Coordinator, with a copy of the Completion Certificate attached in the Appendices.

D. Grading System:		• Supervisor will give 70% of the grade based on the student's performance using the evaluation sheet to be provided at the last week of the approved training schedule. <i>(attached from the letter of approval form)</i> • OJT Coordinator will give 30% of the grade based on the student's submissions (portfolio and daily journal) and one-time Supervisor-OJT coordinator meeting (via <u>online or in-person</u>) to be scheduled after the first half of the approved training schedule
Supervisor:	70%	
OJT Coordinator:	30%	
Total of	100%	
Passing total percentage: 75%		

E. List of Expectations/ Possible Task to be delivered by the student

For the guidance of the supervisors, below are the list of expectations/possible tasks to be delivered by the students. These are just recommendations and to give the supervisor an overview of what specific duties and responsibilities should the student accomplish throughout the training. Still, the **supervisor can deviate from the list** whenever needed. The supervisor and student **can make use** the table below as a **checklist**.

CLO1	Demonstrate an understanding of theoretical knowledge on health physics by performing their duties as a student intern on their chosen institution for at least 200 hours
	Assist in the calibration and maintenance of radiation detection equipment, such as Geiger counters, scintillation detectors, and ionization chambers.
	Participate in the inspection and evaluation of radiation safety programs and practices in various settings, such as hospitals, research laboratories, and industrial facilities.
	Assist in the planning and execution of radiation safety training programs for staff and other personnel.
	Help in the collection and analysis of radiation exposure data, including environmental monitoring data, worker exposure data, and patient exposure data.
	Participate in the design and implementation of radiation protection programs, such as radiation shielding, contamination control, and waste management.





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	Assist in the development and maintenance of radiation safety policies, procedures, and regulations, in compliance with national and international standards.
	Help in the preparation and review of safety reports, safety plans, and safety audits related to radiation safety.
	Participate in the investigation of radiation incidents and accidents, including root cause analysis, corrective actions, and follow-up activities.
	Assist in the evaluation and selection of radiation protection equipment and materials, such as shielding materials, personal protective equipment, and dosimetry devices.
	Participate in the research and development of new technologies and techniques in health and medical physics, such as imaging techniques, radiation therapy, and nuclear medicine.
CLO2	Exemplify professionalism and work ethical standards with different radiation personnel whether in a hospital or an industrial setting
	Attend safety meetings and training sessions regularly to stay informed and updated on safety policies, regulations, and best practices.
	Observe and follow safety rules and procedures in the workplace, such as wearing personal protective equipment, maintaining good hygiene, and following proper waste management practices.
	Practice good communication skills when working with radiation personnel and other staff, such as listening actively, asking questions, and providing feedback.
	Maintain a positive attitude and a professional demeanor at all times, even in challenging situations, and work collaboratively with others to achieve common goals.
	Respect the confidentiality of sensitive information, such as patient records and proprietary data, and follow data privacy policies and regulations.
	Adhere to ethical standards of conduct and behavior, such as honesty, integrity, and respect for diversity, and report any violations or concerns to the appropriate authorities.
	Demonstrate a commitment to lifelong learning and professional development by seeking out opportunities to acquire new knowledge and skills, attending conferences and workshops, and networking with other professionals in the field.
	Participate in community service activities or outreach programs related to radiation safety and health physics, such as public lectures, seminars, or health fairs.
	Take responsibility for one's own safety and well-being, as well as that of others in the workplace, by reporting any unsafe conditions or incidents promptly and following appropriate protocols for reporting and investigating incidents.
	Maintain accurate and detailed records of work activities, such as experimental data, safety inspections, and incident reports, and communicate results and findings effectively to colleagues, supervisors, and other stakeholders.
CLO3	Appreciate health physics as a developing field in the country
	Attend seminars, conferences, and other events related to health physics to learn about the latest developments and trends in the field.
	Conduct research on the current state of health physics in the Philippines, including the challenges and opportunities for growth and development.
	Explore the different applications of health physics in various industries and sectors, such as healthcare, nuclear energy, and radiation safety.





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	Interview professionals in the field, such as health physicists, radiologic technologists, nuclear medicine technologists, and radiation safety officers, to gain insights into their work and experiences.
	Engage in discussions with peers and mentors about the role of health physics in promoting public health and safety, and the importance of promoting awareness and education on radiation safety.
	Visit institutions and facilities that use radiation and nuclear technology, such as hospitals, research laboratories, and power plants, to observe how health physics is applied in practice.
	Participate in outreach programs and advocacy campaigns related to health physics, such as radiation safety awareness campaigns, public lectures, or community health programs.
	Learn about the regulations and guidelines governing the use of radiation and nuclear technology in the Philippines, such as the Food and Drug Administration's (FDA) Center for Device Regulation, Radiation Health and Research (CDRRHR) and the Philippine Nuclear Research Institute (PNRI).
	Develop a deeper understanding of the ethical and social implications of using radiation and nuclear technology in society and engage in discussions on how to balance the benefits and risks of these technologies.
	Reflect on one's own experiences and learning and identify areas for further growth and development in the field of health physics.
CLO4	Create a portfolio summarizing the experience of a health physics intern in the field (hospital, research, or industrial setting)

F. Training Design

- The supervisor has the option to choose from the following training design:
 - Full in-person practicum
 - Hybrid in-person/online practicum (preferably higher percentage of reporting in the field)
- The **full in-person** practicum design is a 100% face-to-face delivery of the training.
- The **hybrid design** allows both the supervisor and the student to have flexible delivery of the training. For example, the student can be in-person reporting from Monday-Wednesday for a certain agreed number of duty hours, and then the rest of the week will be a work-from-home set up, doing tasks that can be done remotely. The online monitoring will be up to the supervisor. This option is also in accordance with the COVID19 protocols of **social distancing**. Preferably, the percentage of in-person training (60%) is higher than the time spent on a work-from-home setup (40%). Again, the supervisor may deviate from this recommendation.

G. Scheduling

By recommendation, the supervisor can choose from the schedule types:

Requirement: 180 hours of training	No of working hours a week	No of working hours a day	No of weeks for completion
Schedule A	40	8	4.5
Schedule B	30	6	6
Schedule C	20	4	9

Note: The **remaining 20 hours** will be spent by the student in **creating their portfolio** and other individual





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submissions to the OJT-coordinator. Only **180 hours** will be given as **contact time** of the student with the supervisor. (**180 hours supervisory tasks + 20 hours of OJT-coordinator tasks = 200 hours**)

The **supervisor may deviate** from the recommendation above. Please note that some students are enrolled in one or two more subjects aside from their practicum. Hence, an additional one buffer week is requested to finish the required hours of training. Moreover, training **design B** (hybrid training) is suggested to make the time flexible for both students and supervisors, preventing unnecessary extension of the internship. However, if there will be unforeseen circumstances, if the student cannot finish the internship on or before the last day of the midyear term (when the students are enrolled for practicum) the **internship extension may be granted** if there will be a **letter of agreement** from the supervisor and OJT-coordinator. This letter will be the replacement for the completion certificate needed in the portfolio, as a partial requirement of the course.

H. Expected **STUDENT** output

Requirement	Submitted to	When
Daily Journal	OJT-coordinator	Weekly
Portfolio (with pictures) in PDF format	OJT-coordinator	At the End of the MidYear Term
Feedback form	OJT-coordinator (required) and/or Supervisor (optional)	At the End of the MidYear Term

I. Requested documents from the **SUPERVISOR**

Requirement	Submitted to	When
Signed Letter of Acceptance Form	OJT-coordinator	Before the internship proper
Signed Certificate of Completion/ Letter of Extension	OJT-coordinator	At the End of the MidYear Term
Accomplished Evaluation Form for the Student	OJT-coordinator (required) and/or Student (optional)	At the End of the Internship Program

Noted by:

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